

child to relax and do his or her own thing. Never tell a child to look directly into the camera—in fact, let the child play around the location when you are taking the pictures. Bring in a couple of the child's friends or your family dog, to make the child more comfortable with the surroundings.



Here, no-one told the children in the photograph to look at the camera. This leads to a very natural-looking picture.

Candid Shots

Photographing a child in his or her own element can capture a level of innocence that you never achieve with a 'posed' shot. Take snapshots while the child is playing, watching TV, reading, or just about doing anything. You never know where you may strike gold and get that shot of a lifetime.

Lighting To Go With The Mood

As we mentioned earlier, light is the essence of photography. The right light setting will accentuate the mood of the child. Happy



TIP

Always work on a copy: this essential guide is new for the era of digital photography. Remember that until you make a backup copy, your digital photo is a one-of-a-kind original. Make it a habit to make copies immediately after loading them from your camera, even before looking at them! Back up your images onto removable media as often as you can. If you don't have removable media—well, you shouldn't ever be stuck in a situation where you don't!